



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:		STAIRS AND WALKWAYS			

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Stairways and walkways in all businesses can be the cause of injury accidents. These passageways do not typically get the maintenance they need, since they are "only" access ways and not production areas. Here are some safety tips to help eliminate exposures at your company.

- Always keep one hand free to use the handrails, both up and down the stairways.
- Keep all stairs and walkways clear of debris and potentially slippery substances such as: ice, snow, water, oil, or grease.
- Keep passageways free of tools, equipment and other materials. Always practice good housekeeping in these non-production areas.
- When walkways and stairs are provided - use them. Don't short-cut your safety to save a few steps or a few seconds. Hopping off loading docks or jumping over piping saves no time or money if you are injured and cannot work.
- Standard handrails must be provided for stairs with four or more steps.
- Handrails can become loose and may need to be re-secured or replaced. Do not assume someone else will repair or report it. Immediately mention any problem to the right person, such as your supervisor.
- Where there are elevation changes in walkways, highlight the change so it is plainly visible. Distinguishing the change alerts those unfamiliar with the walkway to the hazard.
- Secure electrical cords so that they do not lie across walkways. If electrical cords must be laid across walkways, use approved cord covers whenever possible. Consider setting up a caution sign or flagging to alert individuals of cords or hoses in their path until a permanent "approved" solution can be put into place.
- Take small steps on wet and icy walkways. Use handholds to stabilize yourself when they are available. Asphalt and oiled surfaces can also be hazardous because rainwater may produce an oil sheen and create slippery walking conditions.

Unlike some exposures, stairway hazards or slippery walkways can appear overnight. Take action to remedy the problem when you see it.

Discussion Points

Has anyone seen any hazards on stairs and walkways that could cause an accident?

Is there adequate lighting present around site to stop slips trips and falls?

Are we happy with the location of salt bins and oil absorbent pads / spill kits?